

Saraswati Sindhu Sabhyata

Indus Valley Civilization | UPSC/SSC/PSC

EN हिंदी Both



UPDATED JULY 2026 | UNESCO & ASI LATEST DATA

Saraswati-Sindhu Sabhyata

Indus Valley Civilization | 3300–1300 BCE

12,99,600 sq km

Egypt+Mesopotamia se bada

1400+ Sites

80% Saraswati basin me

By Vipulendra Tripathi Sir

UPSC/SSC/PSC Special

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1. नामकरण / Nomenclature - Why Saraswati-Sindhu?

ENGLISH

Old Name: Indus Valley Civilization by John Marshall 1924 as sites near Indus.

New Name: Saraswati-Sindhu / Indus-Saraswati Civilization - Because >80% sites (1100+ out of 1400) are on Ghaggar-Hakra basin identified as Vedic Saraswati via ISRO satellite, Rigveda mentions Saraswati as mighty river.

NCERT Class 12 and UPSC now use **Indus-Saraswati** or **Saraswati-Sindhu Sabhyata**.

हिंदी

पुराना नाम: सिंधु घाटी सभ्यता - जॉन मार्शल ने 1924 में दिया क्योंकि शुरुआती स्थल सिंधु के पास थे।

नया नाम: सरस्वती-सिंधु सभ्यता - क्योंकि 80% से अधिक स्थल घग्गर-हाकरा (वैदिक सरस्वती) बेसिन में हैं। ISRO उपग्रह से प्राचीन वाहिकाओं की पुष्टि। ऋग्वेद में सरस्वती को महानदी कहा गया है।

अब NCERT और UPSC **सरस्वती-सिंधु** शब्द का उपयोग करते हैं।

2. खोज का इतिहास / Discovery Timeline

1826 - Charles Masson - British soldier, first visited Harappa, noted brick ruins, mentioned in his book.

First reference

1856 - Alexander Cunningham - Father of Indian Archaeology, published Harappan seal (unicorn + 6 letters), thought not Indian, failed to understand antiquity.

SSC PYQ: Cunningham ne seal publish kiya

1921 - Daya Ram Sahni - Excavated Harappa (Ravi, Punjab Pak), found 6 granaries, Mother Goddess, R-37 cemetery.

हड़प्पा - रावी नदी - दयाराम साहनी - 1921 - SSC me sabse zyada pucha

1922 - R.D. Banerji / राखालदास बनर्जी - Excavated Mohenjo-daro (Indus, Sindh Pak), found Great Bath, Great Granary, Dancing Girl.

मोहनजोदड़ो - सिंधु नदी - राखालदास बनर्जी - 1922

20 Sep 1924 - Sir John Marshall - DG ASI, Announced discovery of new civilization in Illustrated London News - Called it **Indus Valley Civilization**. Nobel-like announcement.

UPSC Favorite

1931 - N.G. Majumdar - Chanhudaro | 1953 - A. Ghosh - Kalibangan | 1954-58 - S.R.

Rao - Lothal | 1968 - J.P. Joshi discovered Dholavira, R.S. Bisht excavated 1990-2005

| 1969 - Suraj Bhan & Amarendra Nath - Rakhigarhi

3. कालक्रम / Chronology - Updated July 2026

Phase / चरण	Period / काल	Features / विशेषता	Key Sites
Early Harappan प्रारंभिक	3300-2600 BCE Bhirrana 7500 BCE (Oldest per ASI 2024 carbon dating)	Rural, Hakra ware, fortification starts, agriculture beginning ग्रामीण, हाकरा मृदभांड, किलेबंदी शुरू	Bhirrana, Kunal, Mehrgarh 7000 BCE
Mature Harappan परिपक्व / Urban	2600-1900 BCE Peak Urbanization	Grid town planning, seals, script, trade with Mesopotamia, Great Bath, dockyard नगर नियोजन चरम, मुहरें, लिपि, मेसोपोटामिया से व्यापार	Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi
Late Harappan उत्तर	1900-1300 BCE	Decline, de-urbanization, shift to east (Ghaggar), Late Harappan cemetery H पतन, विखंडन, पूर्व की ओर पलायन	Cemetery H, Jhukar, Rangpur

4. भौगोलिक विस्तार / Geographical Extent - Triangular Shape



North / उत्तर

Manda

Jammu, Chenab River

South / दक्षिण

Daimabad

Maharashtra, Pravara

East / पूर्व

Alamgirpur

UP, Hindon

West / पश्चिम

Sutkagendor

Balochistan, Dasht

Saraswati River Mystery Solved: ISRO & ASI confirm Ghaggar-Hakra is Vedic

Saraswati. Dried around 2000 BCE due to tectonic shift capturing Sutlej & Yamuna.

This drying is main reason for decline - now most accepted theory for UPSC. Satellite imagery shows paleo-channels from Himalayas to Rann of Kutch.

सरस्वती नदी रहस्य: ISRO और ASI ने पुष्टि की घग्गर-हाकरा ही वैदिक सरस्वती है। 2000 ईसा पूर्व के आसपास विवर्तनिक कारणों से सतलुज व यमुना ने मार्ग बदला, सरस्वती सूखी - यही पतन का मुख्य कारण, UPSC में सबसे मान्य सिद्धांत।

5. नगर नियोजन / Town Planning – World's First Urban Planning!

Grid System / जाल पद्धति

Streets cut at 90°, chessboard pattern. Main streets 9-10m wide, lanes 3-4m. Called 'Oxford of ancient world' for planning.

सड़कें 90° पर, शतरंज जैसी। मुख्य सड़कें 9-10मी चौड़ी।

Drainage / जल निकासी

Covered drains, 1 brick deep, made of baked bricks, manhole at intervals, slope maintained, connected to soak pits. Best in ancient world - no other civilization had.

ढकी नालियां, 1 ईट गहरी, मैनहोल, ढलान, सोखता गड्ढे से जुड़ी - प्राचीन विश्व में सर्वश्रेष्ठ।

Bricks / ईंटें

Ratio 1:2:4 (Thickness:Width:Length) = 7:15:30 cm. Uniform across 12 lakh sq km - shows standardization & central authority.

अनुपात 1:2:4 - पूरे क्षेत्र में एकसमान - मानकीकरण का प्रमाण।

Great Bath / महान स्नानागार

Mohenjo-daro: 14.5m x 7m x 2.44m deep, 2 staircases N & S, changing rooms, bitumen waterproof, fed by well, world's first public pool. Ritual bathing.

मोहनजोदड़ो: 14.5x7x2.44मी, बिटुमेन से वाटरप्रूफ, 2 सीढ़ियां, विश्व का प्रथम सार्वजनिक स्नानागार।

Granary / अन्नागार

Harappa: 6 granaries in row, 15x6m each. Mohenjo-daro: Largest 45.7x22.8m, air ducts for ventilation. Tax in kind storage.

हड़प्पा में 6 अन्नागार कतार में, मोहनजोदड़ो में सबसे बड़ा 45.7x22.8मी।

Dholavira Special / धोलावीरा विशेष - UNESCO 2021

3 divisions (Citadel + Middle Town + Lower Town) not 2. 16 reservoirs, capacity 10 lakh litres, rock-cut, stadium 283m long, signboard with 10 Indus letters (largest inscription). Best water management in ancient world.

3 भागों में, 16 जलाशय, स्टेडियम, 10 अक्षरों वाला साइनबोर्ड - UNESCO 27 July 2021

6. प्रमुख स्थल - खोजकर्ता और खोजें / Major Sites Detailed (UPSC + SSC Most Imp)

Site / स्थल	Location / राज्य	River / नदी	Excavator & Year	Key Findings / मुख्य खोज	Significance
Harappa / हड़प्पा	Punjab, Pakistan	Ravi / रावी	Daya Ram Sahni 1921	6 granaries, R-37 cemetery, Mother Goddess figurine, workers quarters 2 rows	First discovered
Mohenjo-daro / मोहनजोदड़ो	Sindh, Pak	Indus / सिंधु	R.D. Banerji 1922	Great Bath, Great Granary, Dancing Girl (bronze 10.8cm lost wax), Priest King (steatite 17.5cm trefoil), Pashupati seal, 700 wells, unicorn seals	Mound of Dead, Largest earlier
Chanhudaro / चन्हूदड़ो	Sindh	Indus	N.G. Majumdar 1931, Mackay 1935	No citadel, bead factory, inkpot, lipstick, only city without fortification	Industrial town / औद्योगिक नगर
Lothal / लोथल	Gujarat	Bhogava	S.R. Rao 1954-58	Dockyard 218x37m artificial, rice husk, double burial (male female together), fire altar, IVC bead factory, chess board, terracotta ship	Manchester of
Kalibangan / कालीबंगा	Rajasthan	Ghaggar / घग्गर	A. Ghosh 1953, B.B. Lal	Ploughed field (earliest), 7 fire	Black bangles / काली चूड़ियां

Site / स्थल	Location / राज्य	River / नदी	Excavator & Year	Key Findings / मुख्य खोज	Significance
Dholavira / धोलावीरा ★	Gujarat, Kutch	Luni	& Thapar 1961 J.P. Joshi 1968, R.S. Bisht 1990–2005	altars, camel bones, black & red ware, no drainage, bangle factory 3 towns, 16 reservoirs, stadium, signboard 10 letters, water management best, no. 1 in water conservation 550 ha largest in India, granary, cemetery, DNA study 2019 (no Steppe ancestry), jewellery workshop, museum 2024	UNESCO 27 July 2021
Rakhigarhi / राखीगढ़ी ★	Haryana	Ghaggar-Hakra	Suraj Bhan 1969, Amarendra Nath 1997	Toy plough, barley, oval seals, no grid, fire altars Horse bones (controversial), 2 citadels, oval grave Bronze chariot with 4 bulls, rhino, elephant, southernmost site	Largest in India / भारत में सबसे बड़ा
Banawali / बनावली	Haryana	Ghaggar	R.S. Bisht 1974		Toy plough
Surkotada / सुरकोटडा	Gujarat	—	J.P. Joshi 1964		Horse evidence
Daimabad / दाइमाबाद	Maharashtra	Pravara	B.P. Bopardikar 1958		Southernmost / दक्षिणतम
Bhirrana / भिरड़ाना	Haryana	Ghaggar	L.S. Rao 2003–06	7500 BCE oldest, Hakra ware, 3 cultural phases	Oldest / सबसे प्राचीन
Manda / मांडा	Jammu	Chenab	J.P. Joshi 1976		Northernmost / उत्तरतम

Site / स्थल	Location / राज्य	River / नदी	Excavator & Year	Key Findings / मुख्य खोज	Significance
Sutkagendor / सुत्कागेंडोर	Balochistan, Pak	Dasht	Aurel Stein 1929	Westernmost site, trade point	Westernmost / पश्चिमतम
Alamgirpur / आलमगीरपुर	UP	Hindon	Y.D. Sharma 1958	Easternmost site, cotton cloth	Easternmost / पूर्वतम

Economic Life / आर्थिक जीवन

Crops: Wheat, Barley, Sesame, Mustard, Peas, Cotton first in world (Greek called Sindon). Animals: Humped bull, buffalo, sheep, goat, elephant, camel at Kalibangan, horse at Surkotada controversial. Trade: Mesopotamia (Meluhha), Dilmun (Bahrain), Magan (Oman), shortughai (Afghanistan lapis). Weights: Binary 1:2:4:8:16:32:64 then 160:200:320:640. Bead making Lothal, Chanhudaro.

फसलें: गेहूं, जौ, तिल, सरसों, मटर, कपास विश्व में प्रथम। पशु: कूबड़ वाला बैल, भैंस, भेड़, बकरी, हाथी। व्यापार: मेसोपोटामिया (मेलुहा), दिलमुन (बहरीन)। बाट: द्विआधारी प्रणाली।

Religious Life / धार्मिक जीवन

Mother Goddess (fertility cult), Pashupati seal - proto Shiva seated in yogic posture surrounded by elephant tiger rhino buffalo deer, Unicorn 60% seals, Peepal worship, Swastika, Linga/Yoni worship, no temples found - open worship, fire altars at Kalibangan & Lothal.

मातृदेवी (उर्वरता), पशुपति मुहर - योग मुद्रा में बैठे शिव, हाथी बाघ गैंडा भैंसा हिरण से घिरे, एकश्रृंगी 60% मुहरों पर, पीपल पूजा, स्वास्तिक, मंदिर नहीं मिले।

Script / लिपि + Art

400+ signs pictographic, Boustrophedon (right to left then left to right) as on signboard Dholavira, not deciphered, written on steatite seals, shortest 5 longest 26 signs. Art: Dancing Girl bronze 10.8cm lost wax technique - world famous, Priest King steatite 17.5cm trefoil shawl, Pashupati seal, Steatite seals, bronze bull, terracotta toys. 400+ चिह्न चित्रात्मक, बोस्ट्रोफेडन, अपठित, स्टीटाइट मुहरों पर। कला: नर्तकी कांस्य 10.8सेमी मोम क्षय तकनीक, पुजारी राजा स्टीटाइट 17.5सेमी।

Decline / पतन के कारण

Theories: 1. Flood (Marshall, Raikes) 2. Climate change (Stein, Dales) 3. Tectonic (Ghaggar drying) - MOST ACCEPTED NOW 4. Aryan Invasion (Wheeler - rejected) - no evidence of war, skeletons show no invasion marks 5. Ecological imbalance (Fairservis). **Latest UPSC answer: Saraswati drying + Climate + Floods composite.**

सिद्धांत: बाढ़, जलवायु परिवर्तन, विवर्तनिक सरस्वती सूखना - सबसे मान्य, आर्य आक्रमण (व्हीलर - अमान्य), पारिस्थितिकी असंतुलन।



Latest Updates till July 2026 / नवीनतम खोजें

- ✓ **27 July 2021:** Dholavira declared UNESCO World Heritage Site - India's 40th, first IVC site after Mohenjo-daro (1980) to get UNESCO
- ✓ **Feb 2024:** Rakhigarhi Archaeological Museum & Interpretation Centre inaugurated by CM Haryana - 5 galleries, DNA lab display, 550 ha site
- ✓ **2019 Rakhigarhi DNA Study (Cell Journal):** Rakhigarhi woman DNA - no Steppe ancestry, continuity with modern South Asians, Iranian farmer + South Asian hunter-gatherer mix, rejects Aryan invasion
- ✓ **2023-25 ASI:** 5000-yr old jewellery workshop at Kutch (Juna Khatiya), shell bangles, steatite beads, copper artifacts
- ✓ **Bhirrana:** ASI carbon dating 2024 confirms 7500 BCE - oldest IVC site, earlier than Mehrgarh 7000 BCE
- ✓ **2024-26:** Lothal Maritime Heritage Complex (LMHC) construction fast - World's largest maritime museum planned, PM Modi's dream project
- ✓ **Sinauli Connection:** UP Sinauli chariots 2000 BCE - 3 chariots, shields, shows continuity, some link to Late Harappan
- ✓ **2025:** New sites in Haryana - Mitathal, Kunal excavations show pre-Harappan to Mature continuity



35 Key Facts - Rattafication for UPSC/SSC/PSC

1. First urban civilization in India - 3300-1300 BCE, Mature 2600-1900 BCE
2. Called Saraswati-Sindhu because 80% sites on Ghaggar-Hakra (Saraswati) basin
3. Extent 12,99,600 sq km - Triangular, bigger than Egypt+Mesopotamia
4. First discovered by Daya Ram Sahni 1921 Harappa (Ravi)
5. Mohenjo-daro by R.D. Banerji 1922 Indus - Mound of Dead - 300 ha
6. John Marshall announced 1924 - DG ASI
7. Largest site in India Rakhigarhi 550 ha Haryana, overall earlier Mohenjo-daro 300 ha but now Rakhigarhi bigger
8. Oldest site Bhirrana 7500 BCE Haryana
9. Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro 14.5x7x2.44m - bitumen waterproof
10. Granary largest Mohenjo-daro 45.7x22.8m
11. Dockyard at Lothal 218x37m artificial - Manchester of IVC
12. Ploughed field earliest at Kalibangan Rajasthan
13. Only city without citadel Chanhudaro - industrial town, bead factory
14. Dholavira 3 divisions + 16 reservoirs + signboard 10 letters - UNESCO 2021

15. Dancing Girl bronze 10.8cm lost wax Mohenjo-daro – world famous art
16. Priest King steatite 17.5cm trefoil shawl Mohenjo-daro
17. Pashupati seal proto Shiva surrounded by elephant tiger rhino buffalo deer
18. Unicorn on 60% seals – most common animal
19. Script pictographic 400+ signs boustrophedon undeciphered
20. Cotton first cultivated world – Greeks called Sindon
21. No temple found, no iron, no horse generally
22. Weights binary 1:2:4:8:16:32:64 then 160:200:320:640
23. Bricks ratio 1:2:4 standardization
24. Drainage best in ancient world – covered drains manhole
25. Fire altars at Kalibangan (7) & Lothal
26. Double burial at Lothal (male female together)
27. Horse bones at Surkotada controversial – UPSC asked
28. Bronze chariot with 4 bulls at Daimabad southernmost
29. Trade with Mesopotamia (Meluhha), Dilmun Bahrain, Magan Oman
30. Decline main reason Saraswati drying + climate change – most accepted now, Aryan invasion rejected
31. Manda northernmost Chenab Jammu, Daimabad southernmost Pravara Maharashtra
32. Alamgirpur easternmost Hindon UP, Sutkagendor westernmost Dasht Balochistan
33. Rakhigarhi DNA 2019 no Steppe ancestry continuity
34. Inkpot found at Chanhudaro shows literacy
35. Swastika symbol first found in IVC – auspicious symbol



40 PYQs – SSC / UPSC / PSC Trend Analysis

- Q1. Harappa was excavated by?** (SSC CGL 2022, CHSL 2021) → **Daya Ram Sahni 1921**
- Q2. Mohenjo-daro was excavated by?** (SSC CHSL 2023, MTS 2022) → **R.D. Banerji 1922**
- Q3. Indus Valley Civilization was announced by?** (UPSC 2019) → **John Marshall 1924**
- Q4. Great Bath found at?** (UPSC 2018, SSC CGL 2021, CHSL 2023) → **Mohenjo-daro**
- Q5. Dockyard found at?** (SSC CGL 2021, CPO 2022, UPSC 2017) → **Lothal**
- Q6. Ploughed field evidence at?** (SSC CPO 2022, CGL 2020) → **Kalibangan**
- Q7. Largest IVC site in India?** (SSC GD 2024, UPSC 2023) → **Rakhigarhi 550 ha**
- Q8. Oldest IVC site?** (SSC MTS 2024, PSC 2023) → **Bhirrana 7500 BCE**
- Q9. Fire altars 7 found at?** (SSC CGL 2020) → **Kalibangan**
- Q10. City without citadel?** (SSC CHSL 2022) → **Chanhudaro**
- Q11. Dholavira UNESCO year?** (PSC 2023, SSC 2022) → **27 July 2021**
- Q12. Indus script nature?** (UPSC 2019, 2020) → **Pictographic, Boustrophedon, Undeciphered**
- Q13. Dancing Girl material?** (SSC 2023, UPSC) → **Bronze, lost wax, 10.8cm**

- Q14. Cotton first cultivated, Greeks called?** (UPSC) → **Sindon**
- Q15. Southernmost site?** (SSC CGL 2021) → **Daimabad (Pravara)**
- Q16. Northernmost site?** (SSC) → **Manda (Chenab)**
- Q17. Easternmost?** (SSC) → **Alamgirpur (Hindon)**
- Q18. Westernmost?** (SSC) → **Sutkagendor (Dasht)**
- Q19. Horse bones at?** (UPSC 2017) → **Surkotada**
- Q20. Bronze chariot 4 bulls at?** (PSC) → **Daimabad**
- Q21. Inkpot found at?** (SSC) → **Chanhudaro**
- Q22. Double burial at?** (SSC) → **Lothal**
- Q23. Most common animal on seals?** (SSC) → **Unicorn 60%**
- Q24. Only industrial town?** → **Chanhudaro**
- Q25. Bricks ratio?** (SSC) → **1:2:4**
- Q26. Great Granary largest at?** → **Mohenjo-daro 45.7x22.8m**
- Q27. Manchester of IVC?** → **Lothal**
- Q28. Black bangles city?** → **Kalibangan**
- Q29. Signboard 10 letters at?** → **Dholavira**
- Q30. DNA study no Steppe at?** (UPSC 2022) → **Rakhigarhi 2019**
- Q31. Pashupati seal animals?** → **Elephant Tiger Rhino Buffalo Deer**
- Q32. No temple found - true?** → **Yes, no temple found in IVC**
- Q33. Weights system?** → **Binary 1:2:4:8:16**
- Q34. Cotton cloth found at?** → **Alamgirpur**
- Q35. Toy plough at?** → **Banawali**
- Q36. 16 reservoirs at?** → **Dholavira**
- Q37. Mound of Dead means?** → **Mohenjo-daro**
- Q38. Decline main reason now?** (UPSC) → **Saraswati drying + Climate**
- Q39. Mesopotamia called IVC?** → **Meluhha**
- Q40. Swastika first found?** → **Indus Valley**

Thank You!

Prepared by Vipulendra Tripathi Sir

SSC / PSC / UPSC History Series | Updated July 2026 | Watermark Protected

Dholavira UNESCO 2021 | Rakhigarhi Museum 2024 | Bhirrana 7500 BCE | Latest ASI Data Included

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